

Release Readiness & QA Sign-off

Internal build RC5 · Public version 1.0.1 (unpublished)

Status: **RELEASE-READY**. Both QA release gates are passed. No open release blocker remains on the QA side. Nothing has been published — final publication remains a deliberate owner action.

Release gates

Gate	Requirement	Status	Confirmed
1 Adobe acceptance	Interactive field-capacity acceptance in Adobe Acrobat Reader	PASSED	2026-08-21
2 Poppler 26.05+	Page 37 renders correctly on Poppler 26.05 or later	PASSED	2026-08-21

Gate 1 — Adobe Acrobat Reader field-capacity acceptance

The product owner ran the manual acceptance test on both RC5 PDFs in Adobe Acrobat Reader and confirmed: long multiline entries and short fields accept their intended input; saving, closing, and reopening preserve the values exactly; fields remain editable; and handbook page 37 renders correctly. This closes the typeability question that earlier programmatic tests could not establish. Underlying correction: every field previously inherited ReportLab’s default /MaxLen 100; RC5 assigns a deliberate per-field capacity (full narrative / evidence ≥ 300, medium ≥ 180, verifier / confidentiality / support ≥ 140, short metadata sized per field). All 142 fields persist their full intended-length value after save and reopen with zero truncation.

Gate 2 — Poppler 26.05+ page-37 rendering

The local build environment caps Poppler at 24.02, so the gate was exercised in CI: a GitHub Actions job in an Arch Linux container running Poppler 26.07.0 — at or beyond the reported failing version — rendered the shipped RC5 handbook page 37 in every mode, comparing the content top edge and bounding box against the approved PyMuPDF reference (top = 156px at 150dpi).

Render mode (Poppler 26.07.0)	Top edge	Result
Blank — whole document	155 px	OK (within 1px)
Blank — pdfseparate true isolation	155 px	OK (within 1px)
Blank — annotations hidden (control)	155 px	OK (within 1px)
Stress-filled — whole document	155 px	OK (within 1px)
Stress-filled — pdfseparate true isolation	155 px	OK (within 1px)

VERDICT: **PASS**. The page-37 heading and top content sit at the reference position in every mode; bounding box within 1px (antialiasing floor). No clipping, no shift — whole-document or isolated, blank or filled, annotations on or off. (CI run 32530971761.)

Customer deliverables

Customer bundle (KEEP_THE_PROOF_CUSTOMER_BUNDLE_v1.0.1.zip) contains exactly three purchaser-facing files and nothing else:

- Keep_the_Proof_A_60_Minute_Career_Evidence_System_v1.0.1_FINAL.pdf (handbook, 41 pages)
- Keep_the_Proof_Career_Evidence_Ledger_v1.0.1_FINAL.pdf (ledger, 12 pages)
- KEEP_THE_PROOF_START_HERE_v1.0.1.pdf (one-page orientation)

The plain-text README was replaced by the designed one-page Start Here PDF. No source, QA, or internal materials are in the bundle.

SHA-256 — customer-facing files

File	SHA-256
Handbook PDF	7ee951ce...bcf78c2a
Career Evidence Ledger PDF	259315b0...f8717f81
Start Here PDF	5cfc6f0f...c1f9f2fc
Customer bundle ZIP	d2e4030d...d98cbc87

Both product-PDF hashes are unchanged since RC5; the Start Here PDF and bundle are new.

Recommendation

RC5 v1.0.1 is release-ready. Both QA gates are passed and there is no open release blocker. The recommended next step is the owner’s deliberate publication action (website download link and Gumroad delivery). Publication has intentionally not been performed; public version remains 1.0.1, unpublished.